



NSW Education Standards Authority

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Centre Number

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Student Number

2023 HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION

Ancient History

General Instructions

- Reading time – 5 minutes
- Working time – 3 hours
- Write using black pen
- A Source Booklet is provided with this paper
- Write your Centre Number and Student Number at the top of this page

Total marks:
100

Section I – 25 marks (pages 2–8)

- Attempt Questions 1–4
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section II – 25 marks (pages 9–11)

- Attempt ONE question from Questions 5–12
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section III – 25 marks (pages 12–14)

- Attempt ONE question from Questions 13–22
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section IV – 25 marks (pages 15–24)

- Attempt ONE question from Questions 23–32
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section I — Cities of Vesuvius – Pompeii and Herculaneum

25 marks

Attempt Questions 1–4

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Refer to the Source Booklet to answer Questions 1–4.

Answer the questions in the spaces provided. These spaces provide guidance for the expected length of response.

Extra writing space is provided on pages 7–8 of this booklet. If you use this space, clearly indicate which question you are answering.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate historical knowledge and understanding relevant to the question
 - communicate ideas and information logically
 - use historical terms and concepts appropriately
-

Question 1 (3 marks)

Describe ONE modern representation of Pompeii.

Do NOT write in this area.

Question 2 (4 marks)

Explain what human remains reveal about the people of Campania.

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Please turn over

This image shows a full page of a handwriting practice worksheet. It consists of approximately 20 horizontal dashed lines spaced evenly down the page, providing a guide for letter height and placement. The background is plain white, and there are no other markings or text present.

Do NOT write in this area.

Do NOT write in this area.

[illegible]

– 5 –

[illegible]

End of Question 4

Do NOT write in this area.

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Section I extra writing space

If you use this space, clearly indicate which question you are answering.

Section I extra writing space

If you use this space, clearly indicate which question you are answering.

Do NOT write in this area.

Ancient History

Section II — Ancient Societies

25 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 5–12

Answer ALL parts of the question

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on pages 2–8 of the Sections II, III and IV Writing Booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate historical knowledge and understanding relevant to the question
 - communicate ideas and information logically
 - use historical terms and concepts appropriately
-

Question 5 — Option A: New Kingdom Egypt society to the death of Amenhotep III (25 marks)

- | | | |
|-----|--|-----------|
| (a) | Outline the impact of empire on the Egyptian economy in this period. | 5 |
| (b) | Explain the role of the pharaoh in this period. | 8 |
| (c) | What does evidence reveal about religion in Egypt in this period? | 12 |

Question 6 — Option B: New Kingdom Egypt society during the Ramesside period (25 marks)

- | | | |
|-----|---|-----------|
| (a) | Outline the reasons for the workers' strike. | 5 |
| (b) | Explain the role of the pharaoh in this period. | 8 |
| (c) | What does evidence reveal about religion in Egypt in this period? | 12 |

Question 7 — Option C: Society in Israel from Solomon to the fall of Samaria
(25 marks)

- (a) Outline the key features of fortified cities in Israel in this period. **5**
- (b) Explain the role of Israelite kingship in this period. **8**
- (c) What does evidence reveal about religion in Israel in this period? **12**

Question 8 — Option D: Persian society at the time of Darius and Xerxes
(25 marks)

- (a) Outline the importance of taxation and tribute for the Persian empire. **5**
- (b) Explain the role of the Persian army in this period. **8**
- (c) What does evidence reveal about religion in the Persian empire in this period? **12**

Question 9 — Option E: Society in China during the Han Dynasty
206 BC – AD 220 (25 marks)

- (a) Outline the importance of technology in China in this period. **5**
- (b) Explain the role of the emperor in this period. **8**
- (c) What does evidence reveal about religion in China in this period? **12**

Question 10 — Option F: Bronze Age – Minoan Crete (25 marks)

- (a) Outline the importance of trade for Minoan Crete. **5**
- (b) Explain the structure of society in Minoan Crete. **8**
- (c) What does evidence reveal about religion in Minoan Crete in this period? **12**

Question 11 — Option G: Spartan society to the Battle of Leuctra 371 BC
(25 marks)

- (a) Outline the key features of Spartan land ownership in this period. **5**
- (b) Explain the role of Spartan kings in this period. **8**
- (c) What does evidence reveal about religion in Sparta in this period? **12**

Question 12 — Option H: Athenian society in the time of Pericles (25 marks)

- (a) Outline the importance of trade and tribute for Athens in this period. **5**
- (b) Explain the roles of metics and slaves in Athenian society in this period. **8**
- (c) What does evidence reveal about religion in Athens in this period? **12**

Section III — Personalities in their Times

25 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 13–22

Answer ALL parts of the question

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on pages 10–16 of the Sections II, III and IV Writing Booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate historical knowledge and understanding relevant to the question
 - communicate ideas and information logically
 - use historical terms and concepts appropriately
-

Question 13 — Option A: Egypt – Hatshepsut (25 marks)

- | | | |
|-----|--|-----------|
| (a) | What is the value of ONE ancient source or type of ancient source for a historian studying Hatshepsut? | 5 |
| (b) | Explain the purpose of Hatshepsut’s building program. Support your response using relevant sources. | 10 |
| (c) | To what extent does Hatshepsut deserve her reputation? Support your response using relevant sources. | 10 |

Question 14 — Option B: Egypt – Akhenaten (25 marks)

- | | | |
|-----|---|-----------|
| (a) | What is the value of ONE ancient source or type of ancient source for a historian studying Akhenaten? | 5 |
| (b) | Explain the development of Akhenaten’s building programs. Support your response using relevant sources. | 10 |
| (c) | To what extent does Akhenaten deserve his reputation? Support your response using relevant sources. | 10 |

Question 15 — Option C: The Near East – Sennacherib (25 marks)

- (a) What is the value of ONE ancient source or type of ancient source for a historian studying Sennacherib? **5**
- (b) How did Sennacherib rise to prominence? Support your response using relevant sources. **10**
- (c) To what extent does Sennacherib deserve his reputation? Support your response using relevant sources. **10**

Question 16 — Option D: The Near East – Xerxes (25 marks)

- (a) What is the value of ONE ancient source or type of ancient source for a historian studying Xerxes? **5**
- (b) Explain Xerxes' relationship with prominent Persians and non-Persians. Support your response using relevant sources. **10**
- (c) To what extent does Xerxes deserve his reputation? Support your response using relevant sources. **10**

Question 17 — Option E: China – Qin Shihuangdi (25 marks)

- (a) What is the value of ONE ancient source or type of ancient source for a historian studying Qin Shihuangdi? **5**
- (b) How did Qin Shihuangdi rise to prominence? Support your response using relevant sources. **10**
- (c) To what extent does Qin Shihuangdi deserve his reputation? Support your response using relevant sources. **10**

Question 18 — Option F: Greece – Pericles (25 marks)

- (a) What is the value of ONE ancient source or type of ancient source for a historian studying Pericles? **5**
- (b) Explain Pericles' relationship with prominent individuals. Support your response using relevant sources. **10**
- (c) To what extent does Pericles deserve his reputation? Support your response using relevant sources. **10**

Question 19 — Option G: Greece – Alexander the Great (25 marks)

- (a) What is the value of ONE ancient source or type of ancient source for a historian studying Alexander the Great? **5**
- (b) How did Alexander rise to prominence? Support your response using relevant sources. **10**
- (c) To what extent does Alexander the Great deserve his reputation? Support your response using relevant sources. **10**

Question 20 — Option H: Rome – Tiberius Gracchus (25 marks)

- (a) What is the value of ONE ancient source or type of ancient source for a historian studying Tiberius Gracchus? **5**
- (b) How did Tiberius Gracchus rise to prominence? Support your response using relevant sources. **10**
- (c) To what extent does Tiberius Gracchus deserve his reputation? Support your response using relevant sources. **10**

Question 21 — Option I: Rome – Julius Caesar (25 marks)

- (a) What is the value of ONE ancient source or type of ancient source for a historian studying Julius Caesar? **5**
- (b) How did Julius Caesar rise to prominence? Support your response using relevant sources. **10**
- (c) To what extent does Julius Caesar deserve his reputation? Support your response using relevant sources. **10**

Question 22 — Option J: Rome – Agrippina the Younger (25 marks)

- (a) What is the value of ONE ancient source or type of ancient source for a historian studying Agrippina the Younger? **5**
- (b) How did Agrippina the Younger rise to prominence? Support your response using relevant sources. **10**
- (c) To what extent does Agrippina the Younger deserve her reputation? Support your response using relevant sources. **10**

Section IV — Historical Periods

25 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 23–32

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on pages 18–24 of the Sections II, III and IV Writing Booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate historical knowledge and understanding relevant to the question
 - use relevant sources and interpretation to support your response
 - communicate ideas and information using historical terms and concepts appropriately
 - present a sustained, logical and cohesive response
-

Question 23 — Option A: New Kingdom Egypt to the Death of Thutmose IV (25 marks)

- (a) To what extent can Thutmose III be considered the most successful pharaoh in this period? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **25**

Thutmose III ... can therefore be rightly regarded as a watershed in the military and imperial history of the entire eastern Mediterranean ... His accomplishments represent a substantial and imaginative advance over the activities of [previous] kings.*

DONALD B REDFORD,
The Northern Wars of Thutmose III, 2006
Used with permission of University of Michigan Press from
Thutmose 111: A New Biography by Donald B Redford 2006.
Permission conveyed through Copyright Clearance Centre, Inc

* watershed *a moment of great change*

OR

- (b) Assess the nature of Egyptian imperialism in this period. Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **25**

[T]he radical expansion of Egypt's empire, a feat that would become an aspiration for some rulers and an empty boast for others, occurred early on almost by accident as the plunder, glory, recognition, and revenues gained from the new conquests proved deeply exciting.

ELLEN MORRIS,
Ancient Egyptian Imperialism, 2018
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Permission conveyed through Copyright Clearance Centre, Inc

Question 24 — Option B: New Kingdom Egypt – Amenhotep III to the Death of Ramesses II (25 marks)

- (a) Who was more significant in the development of the Nineteenth Dynasty: Seti I or Ramesses II? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **25**

Seti [I] achieved so much in his moderately long reign of 11–15 years that had he survived a little longer he might have confronted the Hittite challenge at [Kadesh] and secured a reputation which would now stand higher than that of his great successor [Ramesses II].

T G H JAMES,
Ramesses II, 2002

Courtesy of White Star SRL

OR

- (b) Assess the significance of queens in the development of Egypt in this period. Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **25**

These Egyptian women were power brokers, to be sure: educated for complex tasks and supreme leadership, ready to hold the highest position, able to see and move the pieces on the board. But viewed through another lens, they were utterly powerless, mere pawns of a patriarchal system over which they had no control and could never hope to alter in the long term.

KARA COONEY,
When Women Ruled the World, 2018

Used with permission of National Geographic from *When Women Ruled the World* by Kara Cooney, 1st edition 2020, permission conveyed by Copyright Clearance Centre Inc

Question 25 — Option C: The Ancient Levant – First Temple Period
c. 970–586 BC (25 marks)

- (a) Assess the significance of Israel's relations with the kingdoms of the Ancient Levant. Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **25**

... late in Solomon's reign when his rule weakened and the state [of Israel] was disintegrating internally and externally ... Aram-Damascus took advantage of the opportunity, threw off the yoke of the house of David and built itself upon Israel's decline.*

BENJAMIN MAZAR,
The Aramean Empire and its Relations with Israel, 1964

* yoke control

OR

- (b) To what extent did Judah benefit from its relations with Assyria in this period? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **25**

In a situation where a small state was threatened by a larger, aggressive neighbour it could appeal to Assyria for support (in return for payment or tribute); kings, if ousted by internal opponents, could rely on Assyrian aid to uphold and defend their legitimate claims to the throne.*

AMELIE KUHRT,
The Ancient Near East c. 3000–330 BC: Volume Two, 1995

Used with permission of Taylor & Francis Informa UK Ltd,
from *The Ancient Near East : c.3000–330 BC*, Kuhrt, Amélie, (2 volumes), 1997.
Used by permission conveyed through Copyright Clearance Center, Inc.

* ousted removed from power

Question 26 — Option D: Persia – Cyrus II to the Death of Darius III
(25 marks)

- (a) To what extent was Persia responsible for its own defeat in the invasions of mainland Greece under Darius and Xerxes? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **25**

There were a number of factors that contributed to the Greek dominance in their encounters with the Persians ... But what proved of most importance in the end, in spite of the disagreements and the vacillation on the part of some of the confederates, was that the coalition of 31 city-states held [together].*

RICHARD STONE,
'Xerxes' Greek Campaign', *Archaeological Diggings*, 2016

Richard Stone, 'Xerxes' Greek Campaign, *Archaeological Diggings*,
March 2016, Vol 23, No.2. Reproduced by permission of Adventist Media.

* vacillation indecision

OR

- (b) To what extent was the Macedonian invasion successful because of the 'decline' of the Persian empire? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **25**

Theories of long-drawn moral decline may be left to the moralists. But one is bound to wonder whether the Persian Empire could have checked the Macedonian advance, [and] whether there were failures of policy.

GEORGE CAWKWELL,
The Greek Wars: The Failure of Persia, 2005

Excerpt(s) from *ON THE ORIGINS OF WAR* by Donald Kagan, copyright © 1995 by Donald Kagan.
Used by permission of Doubleday, an imprint of the Knopf Doubleday Publishing Group,
a division of Penguin Random House LLC. All rights reserved.

Question 27 — Option E: Imperial China – The Qin and Han 247–87 BC
(25 marks)

- (a) How important was Li Si for the success of the Qin? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **25**

In the end, we must acknowledge that the vision of Li Si, the primary architect of early Chinese imperialism, affected the course of history of an entire subcontinent. Most later writers [criticised] him as a traitor and an opportunist, but there is no doubt that the imperial institutions ... were indebted to Li Si's model of centralized bureaucracy.*

PAUL R GOLDIN,
After Confucius: Studies in Early Chinese Philosophy, 2005

* bureaucracy *administration usually controlled from the capital*

© Paul R Goldin, *After Confucius: Studies in Early Chinese Philosophy*, 2005.
Reproduced by permission of the University of Hawaii Press

OR

- (b) How effective were the Han in expanding and maintaining their empire? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **25**

As he dealt with rebellious kings, Liu replaced them with his own brothers and sons, so that the kingdoms looked quite different in 195 than they had seven years earlier. All the kings except one were Liu family members, and that exception was replaced by a Liu in 157. Yet the kingdoms were large and prosperous, and even relatives might be tempted to make a break for independence.

GRANT HARDY and ANNE B KINNEY,
The Establishment of the Han Empire and Imperial China, 2005

©Grant Hardy and Anne Behnke Kinney, 2005,
The Establishment of the Han Empire and Imperial China, Greenwood Press,
used by permission of Bloomsbury Publishing Plc.

Question 28 — Option F: The Greek World 500–440 BC (25 marks)

- (a) To what extent was Persian imperialism the main cause of the Persian Wars? 25
Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources.

Both Greeks and Persians were well aware of the inevitability of a future conflict as a necessary consequence of Persian imperial ambitions; ... we may say that the causes of the Persian Wars lay in the psychology of the Persian ruling class and in the necessities of the Persian imperial system.

OSWYN MURRAY,
'The Ionian Revolt', *The Cambridge Ancient History*, 1988

Extract from *The Cambridge Ancient History* by Oswyn Murray.
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OR

- (b) Assess the role of Cimon and Aristides the Just in the development of Athens and its empire. Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. 25

Sometimes ... a general would gain so much political support and influence as to become the leader of the Athenians in fact, if not in law. Such was Cimon for the seventeen years between 479 and 462, when he appears to have been elected general each year, to have led every important expedition, and to have persuaded the Athenian assembly to support his policies at home and abroad.

DONALD KAGAN,
On the Origins of War and the Preservation of Peace, 1995

Excerpt from *On The Origins of War* by Donald Kagan, copyright 1995 by Donald Kagan.
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a division of Penguin Random House. LLC. All rights reserved.

Question 29 — Option G: 4th-Century Greece to the Death of Philip II
(25 marks)

- (a) Evaluate the success of the Second Athenian Confederacy in this period. 25
Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources.

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OR

- (b) To what extent were Philip's reforms of the army responsible for the rise of Macedon? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. 25

It took Philip less than three years to transform the fortunes of Macedonia through a combination of diplomacy, military reorganization, and skilled generalship ... There is some debate about how far Philip was responsible for innovations in the Macedonian way of fighting, and how much was achieved by his predecessors or left to his son Alexander to complete.

HUGH BOWDEN,
Alexander the Great: A Very Short Introduction, 2014

Published by Oxford University Press, 2014
Reproduced with permission of The Licensor through PLSclear

Question 30 — Option H: The Fall of the Roman Republic 78–31 BC
(25 marks)

- (a) Evaluate the significance of Cicero in political developments during the late Republic. Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **25**

Cicero's reputation as a politician has been harmed by the fact that he was frequently on the losing side. Often his political beliefs have been seen as short-sighted. And he has been criticized for not developing any effective solutions to the pressing needs of his times.

KATHRYN TEMPEST,
Cicero: Politics and Persuasion in Ancient Rome, 2011

© Cicero, 2011, *Politics and Persuasion in Ancient Rome*,
Continuum, an imprint of Bloomsbury Publishing Plc.

OR

- (b) Assess the importance of the military activities of Pompey and Caesar to developments in the late Republic. Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **25**

Throughout most of his period of power Caesar was involved in warfare; some of this was the continuance of the civil war under surviving optimate leaders and Pompey's sons. But it is evident too that ... Caesar was planning the kind of warfare that would keep his troops employed in lucrative campaigning as well as securing frontiers that would offer a better defence for the empire ...

DAVID SHOTTER,
The Fall of the Roman Republic, 1994

Reproduced from *Fall of the Roman Republic*, 1st Edition by David Shotter,
published by Routledge 2014, reproduced by arrangement with Taylor and Francis Group.

Question 31 — Option I: The Augustan Age 44 BC – AD 14 (25 marks)

- (a) Assess the importance of Augustus' titles, honours and images for his principate. Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **25**

In fact, the new name 'Augustus' which he adopted ... evoked ideas of authority (auctoritas) and proper religious observance, echoing the title of one of the main groups of Roman priests, called the augures. It sounded impressive ... No one had ever been called it before ... 'Revered One' gets it about right.

MARY BEARD,
SPQR: A History of Ancient Rome, 2015
With kind permission of Profile Books

OR

- (b) How effectively did Augustus deal with challenges during his principate? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. **25**

Augustus took risks ... and not all of these risks paid off ... the picture is one of improvisation and experimentation, creating the system by trial and error, with chance events playing almost as big a role as design.

ADRIAN GOLDSWORTHY,
Augustus: From Revolutionary to Emperor, 2014
Published by Orion Publishing Group, imprint of Weidenfeld & Nicolson 2014
Reproduced with permission of the licensor through PLSclear.

Question 32 — Option J: The Julio-Claudians AD 14–69 (25 marks)

- (a) To what extent did Gaius (Caligula) successfully fulfil the role of princeps? 25
Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources.

Beyond the exaggerated generalisations or anecdotes in the sources, there is no evidence that Gaius was a bad governor or unpopular with anyone other than senators ... [H]is way of dealing with the senate and his vision for the principate were not compatible with a senate aware of its decline and hoping for a new, young ruler it could manipulate.

SAM WILKINSON,
Caligula, 2005

Used with permission of Taylor & Francis Informa UK Ltd, from *Caligula* by Sam Wilkinson, 2005.
Used by permission conveyed through Copyright Clearance Center, Inc.

OR

- (b) How important was the expansion and consolidation of the empire for the principate during this period? Support your response with reference to the following interpretation and other relevant sources. 25

Great Roman leaders needed to show their military prowess as well as their political skills, and Claudius needed to demonstrate to the senate, people and soldiers that he was an effective commander-in-chief in order to bring legitimacy to his position as head of state. He would follow in the tradition of leading Roman armies effectively and conquering new territories.

RICHARD ALSTON,
Aspects of Roman History 31 BC–AD 117, 2014

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2023 HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION

Ancient History

Source Booklet

**Sources
A – D**

Source A (page 2)

Source B (page 2)

Source C (page 3)

Source D (page 3)

Source A

Extract from 'New things we're learning about Pompeii and its people' from the Canadian Broadcasting Corporation, 2017

[T]o preserve it forever, archaeologists are creating a digital Pompeii using laser scanners which detail every inch of the city's surface. It'll take years to complete, but the digital replica of the ancient city will be shared with experts around the world ...

Courtesy of Handel Productions

Source B

Extract from *Herculaneum: Past and Future* by Andrew Wallace-Hadrill, 2011

[Because of Maiuri's response to the loss of remains during previous excavations] what we see is not an ancient town as preserved by an eruption, but fragments painstakingly pieced together, stabilized, reinforced and 'restored' by Maiuri. In ... the House of the Telephus Relief, the architects calculate that no more than 50 per cent of what is standing is antique: the rest is Maiuri's reconstruction. We have to remind ourselves continuously that what we see is not the raw evidence, but a re-presentation, one done with [great] skill by an outstanding archaeologist, but incorporating his own interpretations.

Herculaneum: Past and Future by Andrew Wallace-Hadrill,
Frances Lincoln Publishing 2011. Reproduced by permission of Quarto Publishing Plc.

Source C

Map of Pompeii



— Location of electoral notices for one political candidate in Pompeii

Excerpt from *Pompeii, A Source Book* by AE & MG Cooley.
Reproduced with permission of the Licensor through PLSclear

Source D

Inscription from Herculaneum

It seemed proper to the decurions to erect in a [busy] place, a ... statue to [Marcus Nonius Balbus], paid for by public funds, and inscribed 'The whole curia of the people of Herculaneum to Marcus Nonius Balbus ... Praetor, Proconsul, Patron, on account of his merits.'

Courtesy of Brian Brennan, Ancient History Seminars

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